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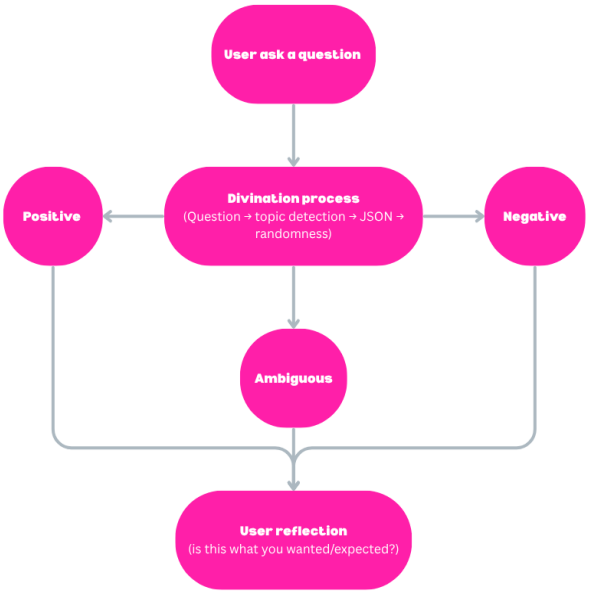
Project #5 - Digital Divination

Advanced Critical Computation 2026

Project Proposal:
The Answer People Wanted

This project centers around the question of why do people tend to seek for external confirmation through divination even when they understand that the answers may be uncertain? Therefore, for this project I want to explore how people may turn to divination not simply to predict the future, but to seek reassurance and external validation for outcomes they already hope for. Rather than questioning the validity of divination itself, it examines the relationship between uncertainty, personal desire, and the willingness to believe. Sometimes we don't need an answer to be certain to find comfort in believing it.

Interaction Flow Diagram:



Technical Steps:

The user will begin by entering a question about something they feel uncertain about and without asking what answer they hope to receive, the system will generate a divination response through a combination of user input, structured JSON data, and randomness. There are a few outcomes of responses, which will include positive, negative, and ambiguous predictions. After receiving the result, the participant will be asked to reflect on whether it was the answer they hoped for. I will use HTML and CSS to create the basic interface for the divination experience. Then use JavaScript to collect the participant's question and identify its general topic through keywords. Then, create a JSON dataset containing different categories of divination responses and use JavaScript to select a randomized response from the relevant JSON category. Finally, display the divination result and invite the participant to reflect on their own expectations.

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